

3 years on...

Work on the DSi began towards the end of 2006

Did you know?

The DSi was originally designed to accept two game cards

Adjust your screen

Press select and hit the volume buttons to adjust screen brightness from within a game




Nintendo DSi

From *The House That Mario Built* comes a system with larger screens, faster processors, more RAM, an internal flash drive, an SD slot, and two cameras. But is it worth a purchase?

hopes to increase the number of people who own a DS within a household: according to statistics shared by Nintendo, in Japan, there are an average of 2.8 DS users per household, but each of those households only possesses, an average of 1.8 DS consoles. The gameplan is thus to increase that 1.8 to 2.8, if not more, and thus to make more money.

The how is where the DSi comes in.

This time, it's personal

Note the 'i' in DSi – “what will you and ‘i’ do”, Nintendo asks. To make the unit more personal, the DSi introduces some hardware changes. The most visible is the addition of an external camera; with a twin snuggled in the middle of the unit's hinge. These two cameras are not meant to replace your digital camera, nor your cellphone camera, for that matter – they are VGA cameras, not megapixel giants, and are meant to encourage casual snapping of friends and

family at social gatherings; and then adding a personal touch (more on that later). The DSi also introduces an SD slot to the handheld family. The SD card is meant to support another personalisation aspect of the DSi: a digital store called DSiWare which will sell software ranging from free to \$8 and above – games, calculators, photo frames, route maps, TV listing, clocks, and such – through which one might further personalise their DSi, and thus one might be more likely to buy a new unit, rather than lend or borrow from a friend, or family.

The DSi also introduces other hardware changes – the speakers are more subtle in appearance but sound much more capable thanks to a new chip; the power switch is now a power button below the D-pad; the volume slider has been replaced by two volume buttons; and the aforementioned D-pad is much more tactile offering a marked improvement in diagonal

The success of the Nintendo DS surprised everyone, Nintendo most of all. Here was the ugliest hardware produced, seemingly burdened with a dual-screen and microphone gimmick – surely a desperate gamble by the House of Mario against the sleek, sexy, Sony PlayStation Portable. Five years, and two iterations later, the DS, which was once the “third pillar” of Nintendo's business,

is now leading the charge with more than 100 million units of hardware sold. Nintendo is clearly printing money here, and the DSi is the latest stratagem to ensure that the printers do not run dry.

Why DSi? After all, the DS Lite is an astounding success, why replace it? The thought behind the DSi handheld is simple: everyone should own one – it is ‘your own Nintendo DS’. With this mantra, the Japanese giant

DON'T LEAVE HOME WITHOUT THESE

You just bought a DSi and now have 1000 points to burn. Here are the best DSiWare titles to plonk those points on



Paper Airplane (200 points):

Manoeuvre a paper plane through an obstacle course for a challenging experience that you will find hard to put down.



Birds and Beans (200 points):

You are a bird. Beans are falling from the sky. The challenge is to collect points before a bean hits you on the head and kills you.